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Week 6 Lit Example Worksheet

JULIUS CAESAR: VALID FORM, UNPROVED PREMISE

Purpose: Apply Week 6's Whately method to Julius Caesar. Run the form test and the fact test separately before diagnosing soundness.

Directions: Use the Lit Example Reader. Do not collapse validity, truth, and persuasion into one answer.

Part 1: Form Test

Question 1.1

Reconstruct Brutus's argument in this form: All M are P; All S are M; therefore All S are P. Name M, S, and P.

Part 1 Q1

Question 1.2

Apply the form test only. If Brutus's two premises were true, would the conclusion follow? Explain.

Part 1 Q2

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Part 2: Fact Test

Question 2.1

Which premise in Brutus's argument most needs factual proof? Explain why it is the pressure-point premise.

Part 2 Q1

Question 2.2

What evidence would Brutus need in order to make that premise strong enough for a careful listener?

Part 2 Q2

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Part 3: Antony's Evidence

Question 3.1

List Antony's three main pieces of evidence against Brutus's ambition premise.

Part 3 Q1

Question 3.2

Does Antony prove that Caesar was not ambitious, or does he mainly make Brutus's premise doubtful? Explain the difference.

Part 3 Q2

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Part 4: Final Diagnosis

Question 4.1

Diagnose Brutus's argument as valid, invalid, sound, unsound, or not yet proved. You may use more than one label if you explain the difference.

Part 4 Q1

Question 4.2

In one paragraph, explain why "valid" does not mean "true" using Brutus and Antony as your example.

Part 4 Q2